

Ivy Graduate Programs Student Handbook

Master of Business Analytics

2024-2025

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Getting Started

Academic Advising

Master's Degree	Advisor	Director of Graduate Education (DOGE)
Full-time MBA	<u>Sarah Wilson</u>	<u>Valentina Salotti</u>
Professional MBA	<u>Leah Berte</u>	<u>Valentina Salotti</u>
Master of Accounting	<u>Kayla Sander</u> and <u>Brandi Moormann</u>	<u>Trinkle@iastate.edu</u>
Master of Accounting Analytics	<u>Leah Berte</u>	<u>Brad Trinkle</u>
Master of Healthcare Analytics and Operations	<u>Leah Berte</u>	<u>Natallia Gray</u>
Master of Finance	<u>Travis Sapp</u>	<u>Travis Sapp</u>
Master of Information Systems	<u>Brandi Moormann</u>	<u>Ray Chen</u>
Master of Business Analytics online program	<u>Leah Berte</u>	<u>Lingyao Yuan</u>
Master of Business Analytics residential program	<u>Brandi Moormann</u>	<u>Lingyao Yuan</u>
Master of Real Estate Development	<u>Leah Berte</u>	<u>James Spiller</u>

Master of Entrepreneurship	<u>Brandon Mueller</u>	<u>Brandon Mueller</u>
Graduate Certificate	Advisor	Director of Certificate (DOC)
Certificate in Finance	<u>Travis Sapp</u>	<u>Travis Sapp</u>
Certificate in Business Analytics for students in online program	<u>Leah Berte</u>	<u>Lingyao Yuan</u>
Certificate in Business Analytics for students in residential program	<u>Brandi Moormann</u>	<u>Lingyao Yuan</u>
Certificate in Entrepreneurship	<u>Brandon Mueller</u>	<u>Brandon Mueller</u>
Certificate in Digital Marketplace Analytics	<u>Leah Berte</u>	<u>Ann Marie Fiore</u>
Certificate in Enterprise Cybersecurity	<u>Lingyao Yuan</u>	<u>Lingyao Yuan</u>
Certificate in Supply Chain Management	<u>Haozhe Chen</u>	<u>Haozhe Chen</u>

Admission

Each program determines its own admission criteria, including essay/statement of purpose, letters of recommendations, resumes, and test scores. If a program requires a GMAT test score for admission, test scores are valid for five years.

The Office of Admission oversees the I-20 process for international students. The I-20 states the date a student must arrive to Iowa State. If a student will arrive after that date, the program must approve and provide a late arrival letter. For Admissions to issue such a letter, they need to know, from the admitting department, that they approve the late arrival and the last day they will allow the student to arrive. The last day Ivy graduate students may arrive late is the 6th day of the semester. A program can deny a late arrival.

Workday

Workday can be accessed through the university website. You will login into Workday using your student ID number or password. If you need support with logging into Workday, please call the ISU Solution Center at 515-294-4000.

Your tasks can be seen in the upper right in the “My Tasks” inbox. You can register for classes and access your class schedule, order textbooks, view/pay your university bill and financial aid information, obtain a grade report and an unofficial transcript, update your student information including address changes, etc.

Career Services

Graduate Business Career Services (GBCS) is dedicated to assisting Ivy graduate students with career growth and development, and to helping employers to identify and

select highly qualified candidates. GBCS works closely with graduate business students to develop a career management strategy that fits each student's professional goals and unique abilities. At the same time, GBCS staff establish close relationships with companies and hiring managers to ensure that recruiting efforts are maximized.

Ivy graduate students, with the guidance provided by GBCS, are expected to take a proactive role in career development. To that end, GBCS provide a broad range of services to enhance students' employment marketability.

It is important that Ivy graduate students take advantage of these career resources beginning at orientation and throughout your studies.

Visit the [Graduate Business Career Services website](#) to learn more about the services offered.

Course Registration

Students should register for both required and elective coursework through Workday during the Graduate Student registration period. Registration for spring classes occurs in late October/early November and summer and fall registration both occur in late March/early April. Students can view their exact date and time of registration on Workday by using the "View Registration Appointment" report.

For information on course offerings, please refer to Workday and the [Ivy Grad Programs Course Offerings](#) list. Sample program plans and degree requirements are listed on each program's website. Students are also encouraged to work with the advisor and/or Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) for assistance on course registration.

Students in Ivy online programs (sometimes referred to as "distance education or "DE") are not permitted to take on-campus classes. This is primarily because Ivy online students pay a distance education tuition rate that limits their enrollment to online classes only.

Class Attendance and Punctuality, Expectations

Ivy graduate students are expected to attend all scheduled class meetings and to arrive for class in a timely manner. Each faculty member sets his or her policy with respect to class attendance, and excused absences are handled between the instructor and the student. An excused absence should be arranged prior to the expected missed class, if possible. If an emergency or illness arises which prevents prior notification, inform the faculty of the reason for the missed class as soon as possible. In all cases, communication with the faculty is essential.

Email: Iowa State Student Accounts

Iowa State's email platform for incoming students is Microsoft Outlook. Your Outlook account was automatically created after you received your Net-ID, and so your Iowa State email address

is: [Your [Net-ID](mailto:[Net-ID]@iastate.edu)]@iastate.edu. Your Outlook account can be accessed in your computer browser through the university sign on and added to an email app on your phone, tablet, or computer.

As a student, all communication from Iowa State offices will go to your Iowa State Outlook (not a previously used email account), which can include correspondence from Admissions, Financial Aid, the Registrar's Office, your academic adviser, your instructors and others. In other words, you are responsible for checking the information that is sent to you via your Outlook account, so it is important to check it regularly, even before you arrive on campus.

English Placement Test for Non-Native Speakers and Oral English Certification Test

Source: Graduate College Handbook, sec. 4.4.3

Graduate students whose native language is not English and who do not have a bachelor's or advanced degree from ISU or a U.S. institution, or do not meet the TOEFL or IELTS exemption score range, must take the English Placement Test at the beginning of their first semester of enrollment. This test is administered by the Department of English. It must be taken in addition to TOEFL (Test of English as a Foreign Language), which is taken as part of the admissions process. A student who does not pass this examination is assigned to one or more courses in the English 99 and 101 series. This coursework must be completed during the first year of study. Registration holds are placed on the student's account if the student does not register for these classes during the first year of study. (There is a developmental course fee for the English 99 course.)

A graduate student whose native language is not English may be automatically exempted if one of the following is met:

1. Graduate student earned a TOEFL PBT score of 600 or above or a TOEFL iBT score of 100 and above
2. Graduate student earned a score of 7.5 or above on the IELTS Academic test
3. Graduate student scored a 72 or above on the PTE (Pearson Test of English) Academic test
4. Graduate student's primary language* as reflected in their ISU student records is English and they completed their education in an English-speaking country**
5. Graduate student's primary language is not English, but they received a Bachelor's, Master's, or Doctoral degree from an English-medium university in an English-speaking country**
6. Graduate student's only enrollment is in a fully online, distance-only program.*** (Note: Graduate students who take any classes on ISU's campus in Ames as part of their program are not considered distance-only and thus are not exempt).
7. Graduate student has been employed full-time (40 hours per week minimum) for at least two years in organizations that use English as the primary language for both written and spoken forms of communication. To qualify for this exemption, admitted graduate students must provide verifiable evidence (typically a written statement from a supervisor) attesting to the fact that (a) the parts of their work that involve writing and speaking are conducted primarily in English, and (b) the ability to communicate effectively in both written and spoken English is considered a requirement of the position. The exemption will not apply to graduate students who use English:
 - only occasionally in the workplace (e.g., only when meeting with foreign clients);

- for written workplace communication (reports, emails, etc.) while primarily speaking in languages other than English, or;
- for speaking in the workplace (discussions, presentations, etc.) while primarily writing in languages other than English.
 - Note: Only students admitted to the Graduate College in Fall 2023 or afterward are eligible for this exemption. Assistantship appointments held as a graduate student are not considered professional experience for this purpose, though full-time postdoctoral appointments are.

8. International exchange students****who do not plan to take classes offered by the Department of English.

*A list of fully online, distance-only programs can be found on the Office of the Registrar website:

<https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/mandatory-fees/online-and-distance-education-programs>.

****Exchange students are those who come to ISU from another country as part of a formal exchange program to spend a semester or academic year attending classes and participating in campus life. They continue to be enrolled full-time and earn credits toward their degree at their home institution.

Oral English Certification Test

The Oral English Certification Test (OECT) is an academic test required for international teaching assistants (ITAs), i.e. graduate students who fit **both** of these categories:

- international graduate students who are not native speakers of American English (i.e., learned another language first), and
- international graduate students who are appointed to a teaching assistantship.

The OECT is administered before the beginning of fall and spring semesters for first-time test-takers, as well as at the end of these semesters for ITAs re-taking the test. The OECT testing dates can be found on the International Teaching Assistants Program website at <https://cce.grad-college.iastate.edu/speaking/oect-for-itas>. Registration for the OECT can be completed online through the program's website two to three weeks before the testing dates. International Teaching Assistants (ITAs) and faculty with questions about OECT should email itas@iastate.edu or call 515-294-1958 or 515-294-7996.

A prospective ITA who does not pass OECT is required to complete English 180 coursework and be retested successfully. English 180 is a series of oral communication courses designed to help ITAs improve their English - speaking skills by focusing on pronunciation, listening, classroom-communication strategies, question-handling, teaching and lecturing skills, and the culture of U.S. university life (<https://cce.grad-college.iastate.edu/courses/speaking-courses>). Because enrollment is restricted, ITAs cannot register for English 180 courses online through AccessPlus. ITAs must go to the CCE in the Graduate College, 1137 Pearson, upon receiving the OECT scores to obtain permission to enter the course by completing an online schedule change form.

Graduate Assistantships

A limited number of graduate assistantships are available to qualified, full-time students on a competitive basis. Graduate assistantships may be research, or administrative appointments. Most assistantships are offered on a ¼-time basis (10 hours per week). Students may apply for assistantship positions when applying to their academic program or by completing the Graduate Assistantship Application available by contacting the Ivy Graduate Programs Office. Students are also encouraged to pursue assistantships throughout the university and associated centers.

The maximum length of time for which a student will be funded with a graduate assistantship is the expected time period for completion of the degree, which is four semesters, except for the MSIS program which is limited to three semesters. Additionally, you must maintain satisfactory work performance for renewal of your graduate assistantship appointment. Students may be required to work during break periods at the discretion of the supervising faculty. Students who are on probation may not be eligible to continue on assistantship or may have their tuition scholarship revoked. All Ivy Graduate students must enroll in a minimum of 6 credits during the semesters they have their GA position.

Students awarded an assistantship will be required to complete an LOI and agree to the terms and conditions of the appointment shared in Workday. Graduate assistants are required to submit weekly timesheets by midnight on Sundays. [A full overview of the Ivy Graduate Assistantship is available here.](#)

Graduate assistants are responsible for maintaining regular communication with their supervising faculty and to perform the duties assigned in a timely manner. Performance evaluation of graduate assistants is conducted each semester. Students who do not perform satisfactorily may jeopardize the renewal of their assistantship appointments.

All Ivy graduate students are expected to know and follow the [Ivy College of Business Professional Standards and Expectations](#) and [Iowa State University's Principles of Community](#).

Ivy Excellence Hourly Positions

The Ivy College of Business Ivy Excellence graduate student positions are offered to current Ivy graduate students enrolled in fulltime programs. All Ivy Graduate students must enroll in a minimum of 6 credits during the semesters they have their position. Students below full-time status will have their scholarships prorated. These positions are paid hourly and include job duties that are not directly related to an Ivy student's academic program. In each academic year, we award 30-35 Ivy Excellence positions that help support work in the Ivy College of Business.

Ivy Excellence students receive the following benefits:

Hourly wage of \$25/hour for 10 hours/week for a total of 170 hours each semester.

Ivy Excellence scholarship based on residency status.

Students are considered for Ivy Excellence awards at the time of admission. However, if openings become available, [students may apply through the application](#). The application requires that you upload a current resume and cover letter. Positions are highly competitive and reviewed each semester. Students on assistantships are not eligible for Ivy Excellence positions.

Graduate College Handbook

In addition to this Ivy Program Handbook, the Graduate College provides a university-wide handbook. The Graduate College Handbook is a comprehensive resource for policies and procedures that pertain to graduate students and postdoctoral scholars. Members of the graduate faculty craft policies through their elective representatives on the Graduate Council. Faculty and staff in the Graduate College implement the policies as efficiently and fairly as possible. Students and faculty are invited to collaborate with their representatives on the Graduate Council to enact policy changes that may improve graduate education at Iowa State University. [View the Graduate College Handbook here.](#)

ISUCard

The [ISUCard](#) is your student identification card. Your nine-digit, student ID is the middle set of numbers on your ISUCard. You can obtain your card at the ISUCard Office located in 0530 Beardshear Hall. Distance students are not required to have an ISU card, but they may obtain one. Please call the ISU Card Office for more information, 515-294-2727.

Onboarding: Ivy Graduate New Student

For all new students, the Ivy graduate student experience begins with new student onboarding.

- Full-time graduate students will have onboarding on campus in Ames on the Friday prior to the start of the semester. Students will attend informational sessions providing helpful tools to begin their graduate coursework, and become acquainted with Ivy faculty, staff, and classmates.
- Full-time Ivy MBA students will have onboarding the Friday before the start of the semester, and during the first week of the semester on campus in Ames.
- Professional MBA students will attend onboarding during the first week of the semester in the evenings at the Ivy Professional MBA classroom suite located in the Capital Square Building in Des Moines.
- Distance education students will have an orientation kick off the week before classes begin with their DOGES, staff and classmates, virtually.

Textbooks

Textbooks and course packets for classes can be ordered through University Book Store by logging into Workday or via the book store website: www.isubookstore.com.

Grade Reports

Semester grades typically become available one week following the end of each term. Students can obtain final grades reports in Workday.

Please note that concurrent students (with undergraduate coursework taken simultaneously with graduate coursework) may need to complete the internal transfer. Student in more than one graduate program may also need to use the internal transfer form to move coursework from the appropriate program of study. [Internal Transfer Form Directions](#)

Reassign Registrations

- Concurrent or Graduate Students may request to move a course from one record to another record- requires approval.
 - Reassigning registrations can be done at anytime.
 - Students should use multiple Saved Schedules to ensure courses are registered to the correct academic record at registration.

Internal Articulation

- Concurrent or Graduate Students may request a course to articulate to two academic records- requires approval.
 - Internal articulations can only be processed after grades are posted.

Enrollment Requirements

During the academic year, graduate students not on assistantship must be registered for a minimum of nine credits to be considered full-time students or five credits to be considered half-time students. Students on an assistantship appointment during the academic year are considered full-time. International students enrolled in a residential, on-campus program must take at least 6 credits in-person each semester.

Credit Limits

Course registration is limited to a maximum of 15 credits per semester (10 credits for summer session) for graduate students. Maximum limits for graduate students can be found in the Graduate College Handbook under section 2.1.6. The credit-hour limits for graduate students may be exceeded only in exceptional circumstances with the approval of the major professor/advisor. To request an increase to your credit limit, please contact your Ivy academic advisor.

Independent Study

The pedagogical intent of the Independent Study, 590, course is to provide an individualized project/research experience for MBA students guided by a faculty in the Ivy College of Business. Each independent study must generate a research project and a documented academic paper under the direction of the faculty member. It is the faculty member's prerogative to agree or not to serve as a project advisor.

Employment and internships do not constitute in and of themselves a sufficient basis for independent study credit. If the experience generates research project potential, then credit may be negotiated.

In general, if a program requires experiential credit, the student may register for either BUSAD 590 or BUSAD 591, according to the DOGE's direction. For a 3-credit experience, a student must work 120 hours over 12 weeks (10 hours/week, which is equivalent to 40 hours/per credit).

While specific outcomes and deliverables are determined by the faculty and DOGE, it is recommended that in addition to the hours worked, a student also submit a 3–5-page summary of experience, gives a final presentation/sales plan (or another final assignment agreed upon by instructor/employers).

To enroll in an independent study, students must first complete the Independent Study Request Form available in the Graduate Business Programs Office or at:

<https://iastate.app.box.com/file/822388989832?s=rcim53h3r1vx9whzcpb4dihdb4wmuemx>

The completed and signed request form is then submitted to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office to receive course registration information. A maximum of three credits of independent study may be applied towards degree requirements.

Employer Tuition Reimbursement and Early Release of Grades

Students participating in an employer tuition reimbursement program may request an early grade confirmation letter. Students will need to contact their course instructor(s) and

request that final grade(s) be reported to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office before an early grade confirmation letter can be prepared.

Tuition

Tuition information is provided by the Office of the Registrar. A breakdown of fees is available on their [website](#). Tuition and Fees are applied directly to your university bill, which can be found on Workday. For questions, please contact scheduling and fees 515-294-1840 or schedfees@iastate.edu

Transfer and Undergraduate Credit

Courses Taken as an ISU Undergraduate

- Courses at the 400 and 500 levels listed in the ISU Catalog may be used in the plan of study even though they were taken by the student as an undergraduate at ISU.
- Up to 6 credits earned as an ISU undergraduate may be used to meet the requirements of an Ivy Specialty Masters graduate degree. These credits must be approved by the student's DOGE.
- These 6 credits must be at the 400 level or higher
- Grades of B or better are required in the courses that led to these credits.
- These credits must have been earned when the student was classified as an undergraduate, not as a nondegree undergraduate (special) student.
- See 6.3.2 of the Graduate College Handbook to ensure compliance with Graduate College policy as well.

Undergraduate-Level Courses Taken as a Graduate Student on an Academic Plan

- With DOGE approval, graduate students will be permitted to use undergraduate classes from both within and outside of their majors on academic plans
- No 1000- or 2000-level classes may be used, but all 3000- and 4000-level classes at Iowa State (not undergraduate classes from other institutions) will be eligible. However, 3000-level courses must be outside the student's major.
- Ivy Specialty Masters students are limited to 6 credits at the undergraduate level, with a limit of 3 credits at the 3000 level. 3000-level courses must be outside the student's major
- See 5.1.2 of the Graduate College Handbook to ensure compliance with Graduate College policy as well.

Transfer Credits

At the discretion of the DOGE, and with the approval of the program and the Graduate College, graduate credits earned as a graduate student at another institution may be transferred if the grade was B or better, as long as the transfer institution is an AACSB-accredited business school. Most Ivy Specialty masters programs are limited to 6 transfer credits. The 6-credit limit ensures that students meet the Graduate College's policy that at least 22 graduate credits must be earned at ISU.

See 6.3.8 of the Graduate College Handbook to ensure compliance with Graduate College policy as well.

Progressing Through Your Program

Academic Progress

Ivy graduate students are expected to make satisfactory academic progress during their graduate business studies. Students are placed on academic probation if their cumulative GPA falls below 3.00, and a hold is placed on future class registrations. Students on academic probation must consult with their academic advisor or DOGE to develop a plan for academic improvement and receive permission for continued enrollment in the program.

Students who are on assistantships must remain in good academic standing (not on probation) to maintain their assistantship. Students who are on probation may not be eligible to continue on assistantship or may have their tuition scholarship revoked.

Graduate students must complete all courses listed on their program of study with at least a C grade in each course and have achieved a minimum cumulative GPA of 3.00 to graduate.

Commencement

Graduation is a time of celebration of your academic accomplishments so participation in commencement ceremonies is highly encouraged. As an Ivy graduate student, you have a lot to celebrate! We know you've put in many hours of study, and we are so proud of you! Invite your family, friends, and cheering section to join you. At the Ivy College of Business convocation, hosted at Hilton Coliseum, your Ivy faculty and staff will be there to congratulate you and your peers.

During the 60–75-minute ceremony, you'll sit with other students in your program, cross the stage as your name is read, have your picture taken, and receive a small gift. Seating is unlimited at Hilton and tickets are not required for admission. You'll be invited to RSVP through email two or three weeks prior to convocation.

Diplomas are not handed out at the Ivy College of Business convocation ceremony, but rather can be:

- Picked up by the graduate in [214 Enrollment Services](#), or
- Mailed to you two to three weeks after graduation. [Learn more here](#).

Want more celebration? Consider attending the [university graduate college ceremony](#). If you are a concurrent undergraduate/graduate student, you may also attend your [undergraduate program's convocation](#) event. There are many options for you to select from, but please RSVP so that event coordinators know to expect you.

Students who graduate in the summer have the option to attend the spring or the fall ceremony. Make sure you apply for summer since that is when you will complete all degree requirements. If you choose to walk in the spring, the “diploma/ceremony” option will be available in March. If you choose to walk in the fall ceremony, that option will be available in mid-June.

Graduates must wear full regalia for university ceremonies. You can rent or purchase your regalia at the [University Bookstore](#). The Ivy Graduate Programs Office has a limited number of master’s graduation hoods which are loaned to graduates on a first-come, first-served basis. [Watch a quick tutorial on how to wear your regalia.](#)

Ivy graduate students will wear the following regalia:

- Masters gown
- Drab masters hood
- Cap
- Black tassel

Iowa State University nor the Ivy College of Business does not hold commencement ceremonies in the summer. However, summer graduates may participate in either the previous spring or following fall university commencements.

Learn more about graduation at the [university’s graduation FAQ](#) page.

Degree Completion

Ivy graduate students are expected to complete their programs in a timely manner. Full-time students need to be aware that prolonging graduation beyond the expected completion time period is unacceptable and will only be granted for valid academic reasons such as a semester co-op or internship experience. Students who plan to extend their studies beyond the intended timelines must submit a request in writing explaining the rationale for the extension and their expected date of graduation.

The Graduate College's time-to-degree limit for all graduate students, both master's and Ph.D., is seven years.

Graduation Procedures

As you approach graduation, there are important steps you’ll need to follow. Students are encouraged to complete these steps as early in the semester as possible. See [full details on the Graduate College’s graduation process](#). The Graduate College has firm deadlines for completion procedures. [View these Graduate College deadlines here](#). Below are the steps required to graduate.

1. Submit Your Graduate Committee Membership. [See the instructions here](#).
2. Submit Your Academic Plan. [See the instructions here](#).
3. Apply for Program Completion. [See the instructions here](#).
4. Final Coursework check via Workday. Instructions Pending

Ivy graduates are asked to complete an employment survey, administered by Graduate Business Career Services, late in the semester of graduation.

Are you a Masters of Information Systems (MSIS) major? See additional steps below:

Schedule your final oral exam with your committee and once scheduled, submit a request for final oral examination to the Graduate College; it will vary each semester, a request must be submitted three weeks prior (no late requests will be accepted.)

1. Submit the final oral [Online Examination Request](#) form to the Graduate College *at least three weeks prior* to your scheduled exam. Students who do not meet this deadline will have their graduation cancelled by the Graduate College.
2. Submit your creative component to ISU Digital Repository
3. Create an account in the [ISU Digital Repository](#)
4. Submit your creative component to the Graduate College via the [Creative Component Submission](#) form.

The Graduate College requires all students to submit their creative component, but they do not review the contents. Meaning, if your committee has approved your final oral exam/graduation, this is what determines if you have successfully completed the program.

Student Life

Graduate Lounge

All Ivy College of Business graduate students have access to the Tahira and Labh Hira Graduate Student Lounge. The lounge is located at room 2141 Gerdin and can be accessed using your ISU card. Just click your ISU card on the dark grey box near the door, and you are in!

The Lounge is a great place to meet for group projects, work on individual assignments, eat a meal, or grab a quick nap between classes.

The lounge includes tables, chairs and a couch, a kitchenette with a microwave refrigerator, and freezer with two desktop computers with free access to a printer.

MBASMA Student Association

All Ivy Graduate students are encouraged to join the MBA and Specialty Masters Association. MBASMA members are actively engaged in planning activities and events that complement the classroom experience of the students. The MBASMA organizes events to promote diversity and cultural awareness, networking, and social interactions among students in the professional masters programs.

Ivy Graduate students can further develop their leadership skills by holding key officer positions in the MBASMA Association. [Learn more about the organization here.](#)

The Community Canvas Page

All Graduate Students in the Ivy College of Business have access to “The Community”, which is an online portal for sharing onboarding information, university and college support opportunities, announcements, and program resources. Students can access the portal through Canvas. Students are encouraged to check back frequently to the portal so that students stay up to date on what's happening in their program.

Student Rights and Responsibilities

Academic Grievance Procedures (Grades and Instruction)

Source: Graduate College Handbook, sec. 9.5.1

If a graduate student contends that a faculty member, in his or her academic capacity as a course instructor, has behaved unfairly or unprofessionally, a grievance may be reviewed through the procedure described below. This procedure may not be invoked more than one year following completion of the course. An appeal of a course grade must be initiated by midterm of the semester following the student's completion of the course.

- o If the dispute or perceived violation does not directly involve the graduate student's major professor, the graduate student is encouraged to contact his or her major professor.
- o The graduate student may contact the Graduate and Professional Student Senate (GPSS) by contacting the senator representing the student's academic unit or the GPSS president. The GPSS will represent the best interests of the student and may serve as a liaison between the student and the appropriate University administration and offices.
- o The graduate student may contact Student Assistance staff within the Dean of Student's Office.
- o Students may contact the Dean of the Graduate College to pursue informal dispute resolution.
- o Graduate students are encouraged to contact the Ombuds Office for unbiased and neutral assessment for informal resolution of a dispute.
- o Concerns of discrimination, harassment, and/or sexual misconduct do not fall within these procedures, and instead should be reported to the Office of Equal Opportunity as soon as possible.

Before initiating a formal appeal, the student may wish to discuss the situation informally with a staff member of the Dean of Students Office for advice on how to deal most effectively with the problem.

Academic grievances should be resolved, if possible, with the individual instructor involved. If a resolution cannot be reached, the student should discuss the grievance with the instructor's department chair and submit it in writing to him or her. The department chair will discuss the grievance with the instructor involved and/or refer it to a department grievance committee. The department chair should respond in writing to the student within five class days.

If a resolution of the grievance cannot be made with the department chair, the student may appeal in writing to the dean of the instructor's college. In cases involving Graduate College policy or procedure, the appeal should be made to the Dean of the Graduate College. The dean will hear the explanations of the department chair and instructor and should respond in writing within ten class days of receipt of the written notice of appeal.

If the grievance cannot be resolved with the dean, the student may forward a written appeal to the Provost, who will convene a quorum of the Committee to Review Student Grievances to hear the appeal within ten class days. Within five class days following the hearing, the Provost will make a decision regarding the grievance and transmit this decision to the student, dean, department chair, and instructor involved. An appeal of the decision of the Provost may be made to the President of the University.

The time limit specified at each level may be extended by mutual agreement of all parties concerned.

Academic Integrity

Academic integrity might best be defined, quite simply, as doing one's own academic work without unauthorized assistance from other persons or resources. More specifically, academic integrity means that students take their coursework seriously and place significant value on learning and engagement in the classroom and while completing assignments and projects. Alleged academic misconduct is subject to Student Disciplinary Regulations outlined in the University's [Student Code of Conduct](#).

Artificial Intelligence

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools like ChatGPT is prohibited where instructors indicate work should be done independently by the student. This includes drafts, outlines, essays, process work, etc. Whether having another person or company or AI tool complete written work, assignments, or other coursework for you, this constitutes academic misconduct.

The purpose of your education and courses is to learn and demonstrate your learning, as measured by the assignments and assessments selected and developed by instructors. Developing these skills will help you as you continue your education and into your workplace in the future. AI-generated coursework will be treated like any other form of academic misconduct. Where students have questions about how or when AI may be permitted for use in the course, you should engage with your instructor directly.

Visit the Iowa State University Dean of Students Office website for more information about student conduct: www.studentconduct.dso.iastate.edu/academic-misconduct/armstu . Read more about the [academic conduct expectations of Iowa State students here](#).

Discrimination and Harassment Policy

In accordance with federal and state law, Iowa State University ("ISU" or the "university") does not discriminate on the basis of age, color, creed, disability, gender identity, genetic information, national origin, pregnancy, race, religion, sex, sexual orientation, and protected U.S. veteran status (collectively referred to as "Protected Status") in its programs, activities, or employment.

This policy prohibits all forms of unlawful discrimination and harassment based on Protected Status. In addition, this policy prohibits purposefully assisting in an act that violates this policy (i.e., complicity) and prohibits retaliation against any individual who in good faith participates in protected activity pursuant to this policy. This policy also provides for the prompt and equitable resolution of reports of discrimination, harassment, complicity, and retaliation. The university's [Office of Equal Opportunity \(OEO\)](#) is responsible for administering this policy on behalf of the university.

All ISU administration, supervisors, faculty, staff, and students are responsible for successfully completing the university's annual non-discrimination, anti-harassment, and anti-retaliation training program. The training program is specifically designed for its target audience (e.g., students, staff, faculty, supervisors, etc.) and is intended to assist university community members in understanding this policy.

The university has a separate policy that governs concerns of Title IX sexual harassment, sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence, and stalking. These concerns are governed by the university's [Title IX Sexual Harassment, Sexual Assault, Dating Violence, Domestic Violence, and Stalking Policy](#). Nothing in this policy shall be deemed to conflict, contradict, or supersede the Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy with respect to conduct governed by that policy. The university also has a separate [Non-Retaliation Policy](#) that prohibits prohibited retaliation against persons who engage in protected activity.

A complete text of Iowa State University discrimination and harassment policy can be found at: www.policy.iastate.edu/policy/discrimination/#Statement.

Plagiarism

"Simply put, plagiarism is making use of other people's ideas, words, creative works and expressions without giving credit or otherwise listing the source of the information. Plagiarism is stealing. Plagiarism is also misrepresentation, and includes handing in someone else's work, ideas, or answers as your own. Regardless of whether it happens inadvertently through sloppy research or on purpose through unethical behavior, it is plagiarism just the same and the person plagiarizing will be held liable."

Alleged academic misconduct, such as plagiarism is subject to Student Disciplinary Regulations outlined the University's [Student Code of Conduct](#). Read more about the [academic conduct expectations of Iowa State students here](#). Best practices for avoiding plagiarism can be found here. Source: Iowa State University e-Library website: <http://instr.iastate.libguides.com/content.php?pid=10314>

Professionalism

Ivy MBA students are expected to conduct themselves in a manner that upholds high standards of professionalism. These standards must provide a foundation for your actions inside and outside the classroom. Students committing unprofessional or unethical acts, whether from carelessness, ignorance, or malice, quickly lose the respect of their peers and others.

If you witness unprofessional or unethical acts, you should first address the issue with the individual(s) involved. Acts of a serious nature must be discussed with the Director of Professional Masters Student Services or the Associate Dean for Academic Affairs. In all cases, prompt attention to the issue at hand is desired to maintain the cohesiveness of the Ivy student body and the integrity of the program.

Smartphones, Laptops, and other Electronic Devices

Beginning in fall 2020, all students at Iowa State University are required to own or obtain a laptop computer or other device appropriate to their discipline. The use of computers is integral to the learning process at the university and students need to acquire these skills to compete professionally and to co-exist socially. [Read more about the university's computer requirement and additional resources here](#).

In the Ivy College of Business laptops and tablets are permitted in class for notetaking only. Other activities such as checking personal e-mail or browsing the Internet are prohibited. Smartphones and other electronic devices must be turned off (or on vibrate) and hidden from view during class time.

Program Overview

The Ivy College of Business at Iowa State University launched the online Master of Business Analytics (MBAN) program in 2015. In 2022, an on-campus STEM-designated option for this program was created.

This program is an interdisciplinary graduate program that addresses the challenges of dealing with data analytics and business intelligence in the “Big Data” environment. This unique program draws from several of Iowa State’s leading educational fields in science and technology including Computer Science, Electrical and Computer Engineering, Statistics, and Industrial and Manufacturing Systems Engineering. The online program is specifically designed for working professionals.

The program provides a foundation in data analytics, project management, statistical and predictive modeling, consumer sentiment analysis, knowledge discovery, analytical reporting, segmentation analysis, and data visualization. The customized, capstone team project allows for focused training in areas such as fraud detection, risk management, text mining, and process improvement.

The learning goals of the Iowa State MBAN program are to:

- Understand and apply quantitative modeling techniques
- Design cross-functional solutions for business problems
- Evaluate data analytic methods and technologies
- Develop skills in modeling and quantifying in unstructured or new environments
- Develop team and project management skills in a Big Data context
- Communicate analytical findings effectively orally and in writing
- Develop critical business analytics leadership skills

Ivy Business Analytics (MBAN) Degree Requirements

The Ivy MBAN requires a minimum of 30 credit hours consisting of five required core courses (15 credits) and five elective courses (15 credits). Subjects covered in the MBAN core include Teams, Projects, and Business Analytic Leadership, Business Analytics Foundation, Applied Statistical Modeling, and the Business Analytics Capstone Project.

Waiver of Iowa State MBAN core courses is rare, requiring special permission from the DOGE. A waived core course requires a replacement elective with the equivalent credit hours.

The MBAN core curriculum is taught in a sequential series of pedagogical building blocks forming a solid foundation of business analytics knowledge and skills. Ivy MBAN students are expected to complete their programs in a timely manner. Students enrolled in the MBAN program are expected to complete the program requirements within two academic years or 24 months.

While the degree requirements are the same between the online and on-campus versions of this program, the course sequencing may differ based on course timing and availability in the two different modalities. Please work with your Advisor and DOGE for specific course planning

questions.

Course Sequencing:

Please see the sample plans for both the on-campus Business Analytics and the online Business Analytics program. It is recommended that students take courses in the following order:

- Background knowledge in statistics and programming languages such as R and Python are helpful. LinkedIn Learning resources are available to all students
- MIS 5320 should be taken first, or as soon as possible
- MIS 5360 must be taken prior to MIS 5560 capstone
- It is recommended to take Core Curriculum courses first

Required Core Courses (15 credits)

Course	Number of Credits
MIS 5320: Foundations of Business Analytics Programming	3
MIS 5360: Business Analytics Foundation	3
MIS 5460: Advanced Business Analytics	3
STAT 5260: Applied Statistical Modeling	3
MIS 5560: Business Analytics Capstone Project	3

Sample Elective Courses (15 credits)

Course	Number of Credits
COM S 5350: Algorithms for Large Data Sets: Theory and Practice	3
FIN/MIS 5410: Analytics in Finance	3
IE 5830: Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining	3
MIS 5150: Big Data for Business	3
MIS 5330: Data Management for Decision-Makers	3
MIS 5480: Data Wrangling for Business Analytics	3
MKT 5520: Marketing Analytics with Big Data	3
STAT 5280: Data Analytics and Visualization	3
STAT 5720: Introduction to Time Series	3

Business Analytics (MBAN) students may also add a Graduate Certificate to their study plan. The Ivy College of Business offers Graduate Certificates in Digital Marketplace Analytics, Enterprise Cybersecurity Management, Entrepreneurship and Innovation, Finance, and Supply Chain Management. Most Ivy Graduate Certificates require 12 credits, (Digital Marketplace Analytics requires 15 credits). Please contact the DOGE to see if any graduate certificate courses can be applied towards MBAN elective credits. Students need to work closely with the DOGE to develop a study plan and to ensure degree requirements are being met.

Employer Tuition Reimbursement and Early Release of Grades

Business Analytics (MBAN) students participating in an employer tuition reimbursement program may request an early grade confirmation letter for their MBAN core courses from the Ivy Graduate Programs Office. Students enrolled in elective courses will need to contact their course instructor(s) and request that final grade(s) be reported to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office before an early grade confirmation letter can be prepared.

MBAN Transfer Credits

Transfer of MBAN course credits from other academic institutions to the Ivy MBAN program is limited and requires approval to be included on a student's study plan. The university must have AACSB accreditation for transfer credit to be considered. The length of time since the requested transfer courses were taken is also a factor.

A final course grade of "B" or higher must be received on all transfer coursework. An official graduate transcript from the institution from which transfer credit has been approved must be submitted to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office.

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